

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250278466

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 04, 2025

Inventor(s)

ALIYU; Farouq Muhammad et al.

COMPUTER READABLE STORAGE MEDIUM WITH PROGRAM INSTRUCTIONS FOR BIOMETRIC AUTHENTICATION

Abstract

A computer system and method having an energy-efficient multi-biometric authentication that includes a fingerprint scanner, a camera, a memory, and a processing circuitry. The processing circuitry reads a predefined probability from the memory and generates a random number. The processing circuitry inputs a user ID and retrieves a trust value for the user from a trust database. The processing circuitry obtains a scanned user fingerprint using a fingerprint scanner and obtains a captured user face using the camera. The processing circuitry applies a reward to the trust value to increase the trust value when the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as the stored user fingerprint and the captured user face is substantially the same as a stored user face in a face database, store the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user, and authenticate the user to allow access to the computer system.

Inventors: ALIYU; Farouq Muhammad (Dhahran, SA), MODU; Falmata (Dhahran, SA), AL-ROUBAIEY; Anas (Dhahran, SA), MABU; Audu Musa (Dhahran, SA)

Applicant: KING FAHD UNIVERSITY OF PETROLEUM AND MINERALS (Dhahran, SA)

Family ID: 93379758

Assignee: KING FAHD UNIVERSITY OF PETROLEUM AND MINERALS (Dhahran, SA)

Appl. No.: 19/209386

Filed: May 15, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

parent US continuation 18313807 20230508 parent-grant-document US 12314366 child US 19209386

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G06F21/32 (20130101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC G06F21/32 (20130101);

Background/Summary

STATEMENT REGARDING PRIOR DISCLOSURE BY THE INVENTORS

[0001] Aspects of this technology are described in an article Modu, F., et al.: Energy-efficient multi-biometric system for Internet of Things using trust management. IET Biom. 10 (6), 625-639 (2021). The article was published online Mar. 30, 2021, and is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

Technical Field

[0002] The present disclosure is directed to an energy-efficient multi-biometric system for Internet of Things (IoT).

Description of Related Art

[0003] The “background” description provided herein is for the purpose of generally presenting the context of the disclosure. Work of the presently named inventors, to the extent it is described in this background section, as well as aspects of the description which may not otherwise qualify as prior art at the time of filing, are neither expressly or impliedly admitted as prior art against the present invention.

[0004] A biometric authentication system authenticates a user by receiving, analyzing, and comparing a biometric trait of the user with a stored biometric data of the user. Based on the authentication, the biometric authentication system allows the authorized user to access premises of an organization, building, secure system, etc. A unibiometric biometric system uses a single biometric identifier, and a unimodal biometric system uses a single representation of a trait for recognition. A multi-biometric biometric system uses multiple independent or weakly correlated biometric identifiers. The unimodal system has been known to have a lot of problems, like intra-class variation, matching problems, spoof attacks, etc. As a solution to aforementioned problems, an Raspberry Pi (RPI)-based multi-biometric authentication system was introduced which uses both fingerprint and face recognition. However, using both fingerprint and face recognition increases the memory requirement, computational complexity, and latency of the authentication system. To overcome such problems faced by RPI and such authentication systems, data was transferred to a cloud server for processing and storage. The authentication systems capture biometrics (i.e., facial and fingerprint images), encrypt them using Advanced Encryption Standard (AES)-256, and send them to the cloud, where authentication is performed. The result of the authentication process is then sent to the authentication systems, which is used for access control. Although the systems save costs by transferring computation and storage to the cloud, the cost of transmitting the information to the cloud remains problematic.

[0005] Due to the emergence of Internet of Things (IoT) services in smart cities, industries, smart homes, personal assistants, etc., security measures are needed at various stages. As the number of characteristics used in the IoT-based biometric system increase, the computation and communication resources used by the system also increase. IoT-based biometric systems face various issues such as limited processing power, limited energy, limited memory, and the

transmission of data. IoT-based biometric systems rely on a cloud server for complex computation and storage. In a conventional fingerprint-based authentication system, a single-board computer (SBC) is used. The SBC is a computer about a size of a credit card that contains a processor, main memory, secondary memory, network card, and other auxiliary resources. The conventional authentication system uses a client-server paradigm, where SBC RPi is used as a server, and a plurality of smartphones or workstations can be used as clients. The server is connected to a fingerprint scanner. The SBC RPi system compares scanned fingerprints with enrolled fingerprints to identify a user. The SBC RPi system has a true positive and a true negative, implying that there is at least a chance that the user will try the system more than once before he/she is identified by the system, thereby enhancing the energy consumption and acting as a restraint for battery-powered embedded system.

[0006] Another conventional face recognition security system uses Eigenface for feature extraction and Principal Component Analysis (PCA) as a classifier. To reduce energy consumption, an ultrasonic sensor is used to detect the presence of a user. When the user is detected, a camera is enabled, and the user's image is captured. A feature extraction routine associated with the face recognition security system collects the data from the captured image and forwards the face segment of the image to the face recognition algorithm. A face recognition algorithm associated with the face recognition security system compares the faces segment information with the previously collected data and produces an output indicating whether the user is recognized or not. This face recognition security system is efficient, but is limited by the Raspberry Pi's processing capability.

[0007] In some security systems, a single sensor (camera) is used to capture both the iris and cornea of the user. Using the single sensor avoids having many sensors and energy overhead. However, the single sensor (camera) consumes more energy than most biometric systems. Also, the image processing adds complexity, and increases the energy consumption and the latency of the system.

[0008] Hence, there is a need for an energy-efficient multi-biometric authentication that employs a trust management system along with a decision-level multi-biometric system for improving accuracy and lowering energy consumption.

SUMMARY

[0009] In an exemplary embodiment, a method for multi-biometric authentication in a computer system is described. The method includes reading, via processing circuitry, a predefined probability. The method includes generating, via the processing circuitry, a random number between 0 and 1. When the probability is less than the random number, the method includes inputting, via the processing circuitry, a user ID and retrieving a trust value for the user from a trust database. When the trust value is greater than a trust threshold, then the method includes obtaining a scanned user fingerprint using a scanner. When the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as a stored user fingerprint in a fingerprint database, the method includes applying a reward to the trust value to increase the trust value, storing the trust value as a cumulative trust value for the user, and authenticating the user to allow access to the computer system. Otherwise, the method includes applying a punishment to the trust value to decrease the trust value, and storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user. When the trust value is less than the trust threshold, then the method includes obtaining a scanned user fingerprint using a scanner and obtaining a captured user face using a camera. When the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as the stored user fingerprint and the captured user face is substantially the same as a stored user face in a face database, the method includes applying a reward to the trust value to increase the trust value, storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user, and allowing access to the computer system. Otherwise, the method includes applying a punishment to the trust value to decrease the trust value, and storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user. When the probability is greater than or equal to the random number, the method includes reading face

biometrics of the user using the camera, reading fingerprint biometrics of the user using the fingerprint scanner, and inputting the user ID. When the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as the stored user fingerprint and the read user face is substantially the same as a stored user face in a face database, the method includes applying a reward to the trust value to increase the trust value, storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user, and authenticating the user to allow access to the computer system. Otherwise, the method includes applying a punishment to the trust value to reduce the trust value, and storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user.

[0010] In another exemplary embodiment, a computer system having an energy-efficient multi-biometric authentication is described. The system includes a fingerprint scanner, a camera, a memory, and a processing circuitry. The processing circuitry is configured to read from the memory a predefined probability, generate a random number between 0 and 1, input a user ID and retrieve a trust value for the user from a trust database maintained in the memory when the probability is less than the random number, obtain a scanned user fingerprint using the fingerprint scanner when the trust value is greater than a trust threshold, apply a reward to the trust value to increase the trust value when the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as a stored user fingerprint in a fingerprint database, store the trust value in the memory as a cumulative trust value for the user, and authenticate the user to allow access to the computer system, otherwise apply a punishment to the trust value to decrease the trust value, and store the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user, obtain a scanned user fingerprint using a scanner and obtain a captured user face using the camera when the trust value is less than the trust threshold, apply a reward to the trust value to increase the trust value when the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as the stored user fingerprint and the captured user face is substantially the same as a stored user face in a face database, store the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user, and authenticate the user to allow access to the computer system, otherwise apply a punishment to the trust value to decrease the trust value, and store the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user. When the probability is greater than or equal to the random number, the processing circuitry is configured to read face biometrics of the user using the camera, read fingerprint biometrics of the user using the fingerprint scanner, input a user ID, apply a reward to the trust value to increase the trust value when the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as the stored user fingerprint and the captured user face is substantially the same as a stored user face in a face database, store the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user, and authenticating the user to allow access to the computer system, otherwise apply a punishment to the trust value to reduce the trust value, and store the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user.

[0011] In another exemplary embodiment, a non-transitory computer readable storage medium storing program instructions is described. When executed by processing circuitry, the instructions perform a method for multi-biometric authentication in a computer system. The method includes reading a predefined probability and generating a random number between 0 and 1. When the predefined probability is less than the random number, inputting a user ID and retrieving a trust value for a user from a trust database. When the trust value is greater than a trust threshold, then obtaining a scanned user fingerprint using a fingerprint scanner. When the scanned user fingerprint equals to a stored user fingerprint in a fingerprint database, applying a reward to the trust value to increase the trust value, storing the trust value as a cumulative trust value for the user, and authenticating the user to allow access to the computer system. Otherwise applying a punishment to the trust value to decrease the trust value, and storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user. When the trust value is less than the trust threshold, then obtaining a scanned user fingerprint using a scanner and obtaining a captured user face using a camera. When the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as the stored user fingerprint and the captured user face is substantially the same as a stored user face in a face database, applying a reward to the trust value to increase the trust value, storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user, and

allowing access to the computer system. Otherwise applying a punishment to the trust value to decrease the trust value, and storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user. When the predefined probability is greater than or equal to the random number, reading face biometrics of the user using the camera; reading fingerprint biometrics of the user using the fingerprint scanner; inputting the user ID. When the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as the stored user fingerprint and the read user face is substantially the same as a stored user face in a face database, applying a reward to the trust value to increase the trust value, storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user, and authenticating the user to allow access to the computer system. Otherwise applying a punishment to the trust value to reduce the trust value, and storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user.

[0012] The foregoing general description of the illustrative embodiments and the following detailed description thereof are merely exemplary aspects of the teachings of this disclosure, and are not restrictive.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0013] A more complete appreciation of this disclosure and many of the attendant advantages thereof will be readily obtained as the same becomes better understood by reference to the following detailed description when considered in connection with the accompanying drawings, wherein:

[0014] FIG. 1 illustrates a computer system having an energy-efficient multi-biometric authentication, according to aspects of the present disclosure;

[0015] FIG. 2A illustrates a graph representing trust values against trials for a genuine user case, according to aspects of the present disclosure;

[0016] FIG. 2B illustrates a graph representing the trust values against trials for a malicious user case, according to aspects of the present disclosure;

[0017] FIG. 3 illustrates an experimental setup to examine energy consumption for the computer system having the energy-efficient multi-biometric authentication, according to aspects of the present disclosure;

[0018] FIG. 4A illustrates a graph of the energy consumption over time for first 400 sec, according to aspects of the present disclosure;

[0019] FIG. 4B illustrates a graph of the energy consumption after 400 sec, according to aspects of the present disclosure;

[0020] FIG. 5A illustrates a graph representing a false positive rate (FPR) versus threshold value, according to aspects of the present disclosure;

[0021] FIG. 5B illustrates a graph representing a false negative rate (FNR) versus threshold value, according to aspects of the present disclosure;

[0022] FIG. 6 illustrates a working flowchart of a moving target defense multi-biometric system (MTMS), according to aspects of the present disclosure;

[0023] FIG. 7 illustrates a working flowchart of a multi-biometric system, according to aspects of the present disclosure;

[0024] FIG. 8A illustrates a graph of performance of the MTMS as compared with a trust management system (TMS) in terms of the FPR, when the TMS is in a best configuration, according to aspects of the present disclosure;

[0025] FIG. 8B illustrates a graph of the performance of the MTMS as compared with the TMS in terms of the FPR, when the TMS is in a worst configuration, according to aspects of the present disclosure;

[0026] FIG. 9A illustrates a graph of energy consumption of the MTMS in comparison with the

TMS, when TMS is in the best configuration, according to aspects of the present disclosure;
[0027] FIG. **9B** illustrates a graph of the energy consumption of the MTMS in comparison with the TMS, when the TMS is in the worst configuration, according to aspects of the present disclosure;
[0028] FIG. **10A** illustrates a graph of the performance of the MTMS in comparison with the TMS in terms of the FPR, when the TMS is in the best configuration, according to aspects of the present disclosure;
[0029] FIG. **10B** illustrates a graph of the performance of the MTMS in comparison with the TMS in terms of the FPR, when the TMS is in the worst configuration;
[0030] FIG. **11** is an illustration of a non-limiting example of details of computing hardware used in the computing system, according to aspects of the present disclosure;
[0031] FIG. **12** is an exemplary schematic diagram of a data processing system used within the computing system, according to aspects of the present disclosure;
[0032] FIG. **13** is an exemplary schematic diagram of a processor used with the computing system, according to aspects of the present disclosure; and
[0033] FIG. **14** is an illustration of a non-limiting example of distributed components which may share processing with the controller, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0034] In the drawings, like reference numerals designate identical or corresponding parts throughout the several views. Further, as used herein, the words “a,” “an” and the like generally carry a meaning of “one or more,” unless stated otherwise.

[0035] Furthermore, the terms “approximately,” “approximate,” “about,” and similar terms generally refer to ranges that include the identified value within a margin of 20%, 10%, or preferably 5%, and any values therebetween.

[0036] A conventional biometric system works in two stages: enrollment of a user and authentication of the enrolled user. In the enrollment stage, a biometric reference template is extracted from a biometric trait and stored on a server. During the authentication stage, the biometric trait is again received from the user, and a biometric probe template is extracted from the received biometric trait. The biometric system computes a matching score between the stored biometric reference template and the extracted biometric probe template. The biometric authentication system authenticates the user if the matching score is above a predefined threshold range.

[0037] Most conventional biometric systems use a single biometric trait to establish a user's identity. However, the biometric systems are vulnerable to spoofing attacks, errors caused by noisy data, intra- and inter-class variations, and non-universality (an inability to obtain meaningful biometric data from a subset of individuals, resulting in a failure-to-enroll (FTE) error). To address these concerns, conventional biometric systems have been upgraded to combine multiple biometric traits (“multi-biometric system”), resulting in increased accuracy. However, this has lead to increased overhead, complexity, form factor, energy, and latency in the multi-biometric system.

[0038] Aspects of this disclosure are directed to a method for multi-biometric authentication and a computer system having an energy-efficient multi-biometric authentication. The energy-efficient multi-biometric authentication includes a trust management system (TMS) together with a decision-level multi-biometric system to improve the accuracy and lower the energy consumption of the computer system. The computer system is observed to drop the false positive rate (FPR) value by a factor of four (4), and the energy consumption is reduced by a factor of eight (8). Further, a moving target defense technique is also added to the energy-efficient multi-biometric authentication to lower the false negative rate (FNR). The computer system is able to achieve 16% less FNR and save up to 2.5 times more energy as compared to the TMS.

[0039] FIG. **1** illustrates a block diagram of a computer system **100** having an energy-efficient multi-biometric authentication (hereinafter interchangeably referred to as “the system **100**”), according to one or more aspects of the present disclosure.

[0040] Referring to FIG. 1, the system **100** includes a fingerprint scanner **102**, a camera **104**, a memory **106**, and a processing circuitry **114**. In an aspect, the system **100** is an authentication system that includes, but is not limited to, a user device, a desktop computer, a server computer, a door lock for access control, a portable or a mobile device, a laptop, PDA or a cellular telephone, a tablet, a netbook, a wireless terminal, a laptop computer, a hardware token, or any other access control system. The system **100** has communications capabilities that can include, but are not limited to, GPS, Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE), Wi-Fi, EDGE, 2G, 3G, 4G, LTE, wired network, Bluetooth®, Near Field Communications (NFC), Infrared (IR), etc.).

[0041] The fingerprint scanner **102** is configured to receive user biometric information and convert the biometric information into a scanned user fingerprint. In an example, the fingerprint scanner **102** converts the surface or subsurface of the skin of a fingertip into one or several images. In an aspect, the fingerprint scanner **102** may be an optical scanner, a capacitance scanner, an ultrasonic scanner, and a thermal scanner. In an example, the fingerprint scanner **102** may be installed directly on, or is otherwise coupled to, the system **100**. In some examples, the fingerprint scanner **102** can be an integral part of the system **100**.

[0042] The fingerprint scanner **102** is commutatively coupled to the system **100** over a network. The network may include, but is not limited to, Internet, a wireless “Wi-Fi” network, a cellular telephone network, a local area network, a wide area network, or any other network capable of communicating information between devices. In another example, the system **100**, the fingerprint scanner **102**, and the camera **104** may utilize one or more wired or wireless communication technologies, such as USB™, Firewire™, Wi-Fi™, WiMax, Thunderbolt™, Infrared, Bluetooth™, Zigbee™, serial port, parallel port, and the like.

[0043] The camera **104** is configured to capture an image of user face and generate the image of the captured user face. In an aspect, the camera **104** is configured to record a video (in some examples, image frames) of the user and to process image frames of the recorded video.

[0044] The memory **106** is configured to store program instructions. The memory **106** is configured to store preprocessed data. The memory **106** includes a trust database **108**, a fingerprint database **110** and a face database **112**. The trust database **108** is configured to store a trust value corresponding to each user, and a trust threshold. The fingerprint database **110** is configured to store at least one user fingerprint corresponding to each user. The face database **112** is configured to store at least one user face corresponding to each user. In another aspect, the memory **106** is configured to store a plurality of user profiles, a set of predefined probabilities, a plurality of audio signals, etc. Each of the plurality of user profiles includes pre-stored biometric features of a user, name of the user, a plurality of security questions, a unique user ID, etc. The user can provide biometric features during registration. The memory **106** may include any computer-readable medium known in the art including, for example, volatile memory, such as Static Random Access Memory (SRAM) and Dynamic Random Access Memory (DRAM) and/or nonvolatile memory, such as Read Only Memory (ROM), erasable programmable ROM, flash memories, hard disks, optical disks, and magnetic tapes.

[0045] The processing circuitry **114** is configured to execute the program instructions. In an aspect, the processing circuitry **114** is configured to employ preprocessing on the received data (signal) such as filtering and amplifying the received data. The processing circuitry **114** is configured to cooperate with the memory **106** to fetch and execute computer-readable program instructions stored in the memory **106**. According to an aspect of the present disclosure, the processing circuitry **114** may be implemented as one or more microcomputers, microprocessors, microcontrollers, digital signal processors, central processing units, state machines, logic circuitries, and/or any devices that manipulate signals based on operational instructions.

[0046] The processing circuitry **114** is configured to determine whether the user is an untrusted (untrustworthy) user or a trusted user (trustworthy) by comparing a stored trust value corresponding to the user with the trust threshold. The user having a stored trust value below the

trust threshold is determined as the untrusted (untrustworthy) user. The user having the stored trust value above the trust threshold is determined as the trusted user (trustworthy).

[0047] In an aspect, the system **100** includes a keypad **116** that is configured to record an input entered by the user. In an example, the input is a user ID. For example, the user ID is a numeric value, a character string, or a combination thereof. In an example, the keypad **116** is selected from the group consisting of a mechanical button keypad and a touchscreen keypad.

[0048] In some operative aspects, the system **100** includes an interactive unit that is configured to generate an audio signal for communicating with the user. For example, the interactive unit is configured to generate the audio signal for guiding the user through the authentication process. In an example, the interactive unit includes a speaker and a microphone.

[0049] Under the program instructions, the processing circuitry **114** is configured to read a predefined probability from the memory **106** and generate a random number between 0 and 1. In an aspect, a system administrator sets the predefined probability (Pr) while initiating the system **100**. The system **100** is configured to operate either as a trust-based multi-biometric system (TMS) or a multi-biometric system. The predefined probability is defined as a probability according to which the system **100** decides whether the system **100** operates as the TMS or the multi-biometric system. The system **100** is configured to choose the multi-biometric system with the probability Pr and the TMS with the probability of (1-Pr).

[0050] The system **100** is configured to operate into two modes:

1. When the Predefined Probability is Less than the Random Number:

[0051] The processing circuitry **114** is configured to input the user ID from the user via the keypad **116**. On inputting the user ID, the processing circuitry **114** is configured to retrieve a trust value for the user from the trust database **108**, maintained in the memory **106**. The processing circuitry **114** is configured to compare the retrieved trust value with the trust threshold fetched from the memory **106**.

[0052] In an operative aspect, when the trust value is greater than the trust threshold, the system **100** is configured to operate as the TMS. In the TMS, the processing circuitry **114** is configured to obtain the scanned user fingerprint using the fingerprint scanner **102**. The processing circuitry **114** is configured to map the scanned user fingerprint with the stored user fingerprint in the fingerprint database **110**.

[0053] Fingerprint matching is generally performed using one of two techniques. For purposes of this disclosure, the terms matching and mapping are used interchangeably. One technique is minutiae-based matching, which relies on the location and direction of minutiae points. Another technique is pattern matching, which compares two images to determine how similar they are. In the case of pattern matching, the technique involves forming a numerical model of the fingerprint patterns and comparing the numerical models. Both techniques vary in accuracy of fingerprint recognition. For purposes of this disclosure, fingerprint matching is performed based on a current standard for fingerprint identification, such as ISO/IEC FCD 19794-3, ISO/IEC 27553-1. In the case of minutiae points, a match is declared between two sets of fingerprints based on the number of points in common. In one embodiment, when a fingerprint is used for user authentication, two fingerprints substantially match each other when there are at least 12 points in common. In the case of pattern matching, a match is declared based on a percentage of similarities between numerical models for two fingerprints. In one embodiment, when a fingerprint is used for user authentication, two fingerprints substantially match each other when the similarity between mathematical models of patterns are above 80 percent.

[0054] When the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as (e.g., substantially maps to/matches) the stored user fingerprint, the processing circuitry **114** applies a reward to the trust value to increase the trust value. The processing circuitry **114** stores the trust value in the memory **106** as a cumulative trust value for the user, and authenticates the user to allow access to the system **100**.

[0055] If the scanned user fingerprint is not mapped to the stored user fingerprint, then the processing circuitry **114** applies a punishment to the trust value to decrease the trust value. The processing circuitry **114** stores the trust value in the memory **106** as the cumulative trust value for the user, and denies access to the system **100**.

[0056] In another operative aspect, when the trust value is less than the trust threshold, the system **100** is configured to operate as the multi-biometric system. In the multi-biometric system, the processing circuitry **114** obtains the scanned user fingerprint using the fingerprint scanner **102** and obtains the captured user face using the camera **104**.

[0057] The processing circuitry **114** is configured to map the scanned user fingerprint with the stored user fingerprint in the fingerprint database **110** and the captured image of a user face with a stored user face image in the face database **112**. In an example, the captured user face image and the stored user face image are a set of detected particular features of the user face. For purposes of this disclosure, user face image matching is performed based on a current standard for face recognition, such as ISO/IEC 27553-1. For purposes of this disclosure, the captured user face image and the stored user face image substantially map/match when all of the features that are detected in each face image of the user face match each other. Particular features that are not detected due, for example, to occlusion, noise, shading may not be included in the mapping/matching between images. In some embodiments, a predetermined number of particular features must be in common between a captured user face image and a stored user face image in order for the images to substantially match each other. In cases where the captured user face image lacks the predetermined number of particular features, the processing circuitry can require capturing a new user face image. When the scanned user fingerprint substantially maps to the stored user fingerprint, and the captured user face substantially maps to the stored user face, the processing circuitry **114** applies a reward to the trust value to increase the trust value. The processing circuitry **114** stores the trust value in the memory **106** as the cumulative trust value for the user, and authenticates the user to allow access to the system **100**.

[0058] If the scanned user fingerprint is not mapped to the stored user fingerprint and the captured user face is not mapped to the stored user face in the face database **112**, then the processing circuitry **114** applies a punishment to the trust value to decrease the trust value. The processing circuitry **114** stores the trust value in the memory **106** as the cumulative trust value for the user, and denies access to the system **100**.

2. When the Predefined Probability is Greater than or Equal to the Random Number:

[0059] When the predefined probability is greater than or equal to the random number, the system **100** is configured to operate as the multi-biometric system. The processing circuitry **114** is configured to obtain the captured user face (face biometrics) using the camera **104** and the scanned user fingerprint (fingerprint biometrics) using the fingerprint scanner **102**. The user is asked, using the interactive unit, for inserting the user ID via the keypad **116**. On inserting the user ID, the processing circuitry **114** is configured to retrieve the trust value for the user from the trust database **108**.

[0060] The processing circuitry **114** is configured to map the scanned user fingerprint with the stored user fingerprint in the fingerprint database **110** and the captured user face with the stored user face in the face database **112**. When the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as the stored user fingerprint, and the captured user face is substantially the same as the stored user face, the processing circuitry **114** applies the reward to the trust value to increase the trust value. The processing circuitry **114** stores the trust value in the memory **106** as the cumulative trust value for the user, and authenticates the user to allow access to the system **100**.

[0061] If the scanned user fingerprint is not mapped to the stored user fingerprint and the captured user face is not mapped to the stored user face in the face database **112**, then the processing circuitry **114** applies the punishment to the trust value to decrease the trust value. The processing circuitry **114** stores the trust value in the memory **106** as the cumulative trust value for the user, and

denies access to the system **100**.

[0062] In an aspect, the processing circuitry **114** is further configured to apply the reward by adding a predetermined reward value to the trust value and apply the punishment by subtracting a predetermined punishment value from the trust value.

[0063] In an aspect, the processing circuitry **114** is further configured to determine the cumulative trust value each time the user is authenticated by the system **100**. The processing circuitry **114** is configured to update the stored trust value in the memory **106** with the cumulative trust value.

[0064] In an operational aspect, the user enters his/her user ID into the system **100** using the keypad **116**. The system **100** is configured to fetch the user's trust value from the trust database **108**. When the user's trust value is beyond a threshold (γ), the user is deemed as the trustworthy user, and the system **100** operates as a lighter version of the biometrics system, which contains one or more biometrics with low energy, computation, and latency overheads. For example, only fingerprint of the user is used.

[0065] When the user's trust value is less than the γ , then the user is classified as untrustworthy, and all modalities are used for authentication. For example, both the fingerprint and face modalities are employed. During a verification process, the system **100** compares the features of the user's modalities with the user's features saved in the database. The verification process is of two types; for trusted users, those whose trust value is greater than γ only fingerprint is verified, while for untrustworthy users both modalities are used. In any case, when the user passes the verification process, he/she is rewarded. When the user fails the verification process, he/she is punished.

$$[00001] \quad T_i = \begin{cases} T_i + \alpha & -1 < T_i < 1 \\ 1 & 1 \leq T_i \end{cases}; \quad (1) \quad T_i = \begin{cases} T_i - \beta & -1 < T_i < 1 \\ -1 & -1 \geq T_i \end{cases}; \quad (2)$$

[0066] Equation (1) represents awarding rewards to the user by adding α to the user's trust value and equation (2) represents punishment to the user by subtracting β from the user's trust value. In the present disclosure, α and β are predetermined values for reward and punishment respectively. The resulting cumulative trust value (after addition or subtraction) is then saved in the trust database **108** (the memory **106**) as the user's cumulative trust level ($T_{sub.i}$). For example, the values of $T_{sub.i}$ is bounded with the maximum value of trustworthiness as 1 and the minimum value of -1.

[0067] In the present system **100**, initially a plurality of mathematical models is developed that predicts the behavior of the system **100**. The developed models are also employed to understand the behavior of the system **100**. For example, one model is developed for False Positive Rate (FPR) known as a FPR model, defined as:

$$[00002] \quad FPR = \frac{FP}{(FP + TN)} \cdot \quad (3)$$

[0068] Another model is developed for False Negative Rate (FNR) known as a FNR model, as defined as:

$$[00003] \quad FNR = \frac{FN}{(FN + TP)} \cdot \quad (4)$$

[0069] Denoting ϕ to be the false positive rate (FPR)—the probability that a malicious user is accepted. Also, denoting ρ to be the false negative rate (FNR)—instances where the benign user is not accepted.

[0070] The user should be accepted by both models (FPR model and FNR model) before the users are classified as a valid user. On the contrary, if the user fails at least one of the biometrics, he/she is classified as an invalid user. Therefore, ϕ and ρ may be derived from the FPR and FNR of fingerprint biometrics ($\phi_{sub.finger}$, $\rho_{sub.finger}$) and the face detection biometrics ($\phi_{sub.face}$, $\rho_{sub.face}$) respectively. The FPR and FNR of a given user i can be generalized as shown in equations (5) and (6).

$$[00004] = \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{face} \times \text{finger} \\ \text{finger} \end{array} \begin{array}{l} T_i \geq \\ T_i < \end{array} \right\}; \quad (5)$$

$$= \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{face} + \text{finger} - (\text{face} \times \text{finger}) \\ \text{finger} \end{array} \begin{array}{l} T_i \geq \\ T_i < \end{array} \right\}; \quad (6)$$

[0071] When the user passes the verification test, he is rewarded with the addition of α and when he fails, he is punished with the subtraction of β from their cumulative trust value T . The user passes through the multi-biometric system when their trust value is less than the threshold (γ) and the user passes through a single biometric when their trust value is more than γ .

[0072] Denoting n' and t' to be the number of trials and the trust value of the user, respectively when $t' < \gamma$. Also, denoting n and t to be the number of trials and the trust value of the user respectively when $t \geq \gamma$. Therefore, the total number of trials and trust of the user are given by equations (7) and (8), respectively.

$$[00005] N = n' + n; \quad (7) \quad T = t' + t; \quad (8)$$

[0073] The values of t' and t depend on whether the user is malicious or benign. Equations (9) and (11) are the trust values of malicious users when they are not trusted and when they are trusted by the system **100**, respectively. Equations (10) and (12) are the trust values of benign (non-malicious) users when they are not trusted and when they are trusted by the system **100** respectively.

$$[00006] t'_{\text{mal}} = n' \times [\text{face} \times (\text{finger} + \text{finger}) - \text{finger}]; \quad (9) \quad t'_{\text{ben}} = n' \times [\text{face} - \text{finger} \times (\text{finger} + \text{finger})]; \quad (10)$$

$$t_{\text{mal}} = n \times [\text{face} \times \text{finger} \times (\text{finger} + \text{finger}) - \text{finger}]; \quad (11) \quad t_{\text{ben}} = n \times [\text{face} - \text{finger} \times \text{finger} \times (\text{finger} + \text{finger})]; \quad (12)$$

[0074] It can be concluded from the equations (9) and (10) that the user will never cross the threshold if $\phi \times (\alpha + \beta) = \beta$ and $\alpha = \rho \times (\alpha + \beta)$ for malicious and benign users, respectively. Similarly, where $n' < 0$ they nodes will remain under the threshold (γ). Since ρ is the sum of probabilities then the aforementioned cases are likely to occur for benign nodes (users) than malicious nodes (since ϕ is a product of nodes). These two equations (9), (10) are utilized to identify that in order for the system **100** to be energy efficient then (from equation 9) more biometric sensors would be needed. More biometric sensors may lead to quick isolation of malicious nodes, however, (from equation 10) to avoid classifying benign nodes as malicious then the FNR of the biometric sensor must be high.

[0075] The system **100** can be modeled using equations (13) and (14) for malicious and benign user respectively, given as below.

$$[00007] T_{\text{mal}} = (\text{face} + \text{finger}) \times [\text{face} \times n' + \text{finger} \times n] - \text{finger} \times N; \quad (13)$$

$$T_{\text{ben}} = \text{face} \times N - (\text{face} + \text{finger}) \times [\text{face} \times n' + \text{finger} \times n]; \quad (14)$$

[0076] The following examples are provided to illustrate further and to facilitate the understanding of the present disclosure.

[0077] During experimentation, the system **100** was stimulated in MATLAB to validate the mathematical model. FIG. 2A-FIG. 2B illustrates the trust value of the user over fifty login trials. FIG. 2A-FIG. 2B demonstrate a mathematical model that predicts the trust value of the user given the number of trials n' and n . For example, ($\phi=0.06$, $\phi.\text{sub.finger}=0.21$, $\rho=0.42$ and $\rho.\text{sub.finger}=0.18$) were taken.

[0078] FIG. 2A illustrates a graph **200** representing the trust value against trials for a genuine user case. FIG. 2A explains validation of equation (14) using simulation. Signal **202** represents the experimental result and signal **204** represents the developed mathematical model of the present system **100**.

[0079] FIG. 2B illustrates a graph 250 representing the trust values against trials for a malicious user case. FIG. 2B explains validation of equation 13 using simulation. Signal 252 represents the experimental result and signal 254 represents the developed mathematical model of the present system 100.

[0080] FIG. 3 illustrates an experimental setup 300 to examine energy consumption of the system 100, according to aspects of the present disclosure. The performance of the system 100 was investigated using the experimental setup 300. As shown in FIG. 3, the experimental setup 300 includes an authentication device 314 (the processing circuitry 114), a camera 304, and a fingerprint scanner 302. For example, a Raspberry Pi 3 B+ is used as the authentication device 314. In an aspect, a Raspberry Pi camera or the Pi's camera module is used to capture facial features of the user. In an example, the DY50 fingerprint scanner 302 is used for capturing fingerprint features of the user. Further, a pyfingerprint code, available in public domain, was used for interfacing the fingerprint scanner 302 with the Raspberry Pi 3 B+. The pyfingerprint code is available to test the Raspberry Pi 3 B+ with the fingerprint scanner 302.

[0081] The pyfingerprint code was used in developing the fingerprint authentication part of the system 100. For the face biometrics, OpenCV (Open Source Computer Vision Library) was used. The OpenCV is a library of programming functions mainly for real-time computer vision. In the experimental setup 300, an Arduino Uno 306 was used to capture the instantaneous power over time. As shown in FIG. 3, a 1Ω resistor R1 was connected along the live wire, making a series connection with the load 314 (i.e., Raspberry Pi). The voltage across the 1Ω resistor R1 was measured by connecting two wires across the 1Ω resistor R1. The wire at the node near the power source was connected to the analog (A0) pin of the Arduino Uno 306, while the other wire was connected to the ground (GND) pin of the Arduino Uno 306. The analog input was sampled after every 5 ms, and the result was printed on an Arduino serial terminal. The resulting energy consumption of fingerprint enrolment was 0.50 J as fingers were scanned twice during each enrolment. During the fingerprint authentication, the user scanned his fingerprint, and the fingerprint template was searched in the fingerprint database 110. When the fingerprint was found (a hit), the user was successfully authenticated. But when the fingerprint was not found (a miss), the user was not authorized. The energy consumption of hit and miss operations was 0.34 J and 0.31 J, respectively. For facial features, the power consumption due to initialization, camera, learning, and recognition were 0.28 W, 0.79 W, 0.28 W and 0.46 W, respectively. Table 1 shows the energy consumption of enrolment and the detection of each biometric technique and the amount of time it takes.

TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 Simulation Parameters during experimentation

Serial No.	Metric	Value 1	Value 2	Comment
1	False Positive	21.50%	27.70%	Obtained from a conventional system.
2	False Negative	18.20%	28.80%	Obtained from the experiment
3	Enroll Time	5.09 s	45.80 s	Obtained from the present system
4	Hit Time	2.22 s	3.25 s	Obtained from the experiment
5	Miss Time	2.18 s	—	Obtained from the present system
6	Training Time	—	51.40 s	Obtained from the experiment
7	Enroll Energy	0.50 J	13.40 J	Obtained from the present system
8	Hit Energy	0.34 J	2.54 J	Obtained from the experiment
9	Miss Energy	0.31 J	—	Obtained from the present system
10	Training Energy	—	14.70 J	Obtained from the experiment

[0082] To examine the performance of the system 100, during the experimentation, the simulation parameters as given in in Table 1 were used. During the experimentation, following assumptions were considered: [0083] 1) The fingerprints and facial features have already been enrolled and the system 100 has been trained to recognize the biometric modalities with accuracy as mentioned in Table 1. [0084] 2) A set of 100 users have been enrolled with 10% malicious users (i.e., spoof attackers). [0085] 3) The system 100 saves the trust value of each of the user and keeps track of the trust value. Each time the user tries to log in he/she is rewarded or punished depending on whether the login is successful, or it is a failure, respectively. [0086] 4) In each iteration, the user arrival is modeled as a Poisson process with a mean arrival time of 6 min. The Poisson process is usually used in scenarios where the occurrences of certain events are counted that appear to happen at a certain rate, but completely at random (without a certain structure).

[0087] FIG. 4A-FIG. 4B show the performance of the system **100**. The most important part of any Internet of Things (IoT) system is to conduct various operations with minimum energy consumption.

[0088] FIG. 4A illustrates a graph **400** of the energy consumption of the system **100** over time for the first 400 sec. FIG. 4A show the energy consumption of the system **100** when the reward is 0.2 and punishment of 0.1 at different threshold values of trust. Signal **402** indicates the energy consumption when $\gamma=1.50$. Signal **404** indicates the energy consumption when $\gamma=1.00$. Signal **406** indicates the energy consumption when $\gamma=0.50$. Signal **408** indicates the energy consumption when $\gamma=0$. Signal **410** indicates the energy consumption when $\gamma=-0.50$. Signal **412** indicates the energy consumption when $\gamma=-1.00$ and $\gamma=-0.50$. It can be seen that at $\gamma=-1.50$ and $\gamma=1.50$, the energy consumption is linear because the users' trust cannot be lower than -1.0 or higher than 1.0 respectively. However, the slope at $\gamma=1.5$ is larger because, the users are not trustworthy throughout the simulation time. The users go through both fingerprint and face biometrics at all times of the simulation. When $\gamma=-1.5$, the users are trusted all the time. Therefore, only the fingerprint modality is used, providing a lower slope (i.e., energy consumption rate).

[0089] For values within the boundary (i.e., between 1.0 and -1.0), the graph **400** has three parts. For example, at $\gamma=0.5$, the energy consumption is linear from time= 0 s to time= 50 s, the energy consumption is exponential between time= 50 s and time= 350 s, and the energy consumption is linear afterwards. The first stage is linear because all users are building their reputation, hence, the energy consumption is due to both face and fingerprint biometrics. The second stage is exponential because it is a transition phase where some users cross the threshold (in both directions) with each iteration. The larger the number of users crossing the threshold, the sharper the bend. However, the number of users crossing the threshold depends on how far γ is to the initial trust value of the users, since the users find it easier to reach a trustworthy level. Thus the observation that the transition phase shortens and occurs earlier as the value of the threshold approaches zero. The third stage is the point where most users have been classified as either the trustworthy user or untrustworthy user, hence the energy consumption is roughly linear.

[0090] FIG. 4B illustrates a graph **450** of the energy consumption of the present system **100** after 400 sec. Signal **452** represents a change in energy consumption with a change in threshold value of the trust at time= 400 s. As observed from FIG. 4B, the simulation time is stopped early to observe the changes immediately after the system **100** is installed before the system **100** starts forming opinions of the users. The trend shows that the increase in the energy consumption is exponential as the user moves from threshold values of -1.5 to 1.5 . For trust values greater than 1.0 , the energy consumption is maximum, and the energy consumption becomes fixed because $\gamma=1.0$ is the upper bound of the threshold for the system **100**; as such the two biometric modalities must be used at all times. When the threshold is less than -1 , the face biometrics is never used. Therefore, the energy consumption is the sum of the energy consumption due to the fingerprint biometrics for all the users over a given time.

[0091] FIG. 5A-FIG. 5B show the performance of the system **100** in terms of accuracy. FPR is the ratio of false positive (FP) cases to total instances involving malicious user (i.e., false positives (FP) and true negatives (TN)), while FNR is the ratio of the false negative (FN) trials to the total instances non-malicious user (i.e., false negatives (FN) and true positives (TP)) as shown in equations (3) and (4), respectively.

[0092] A TP metric represents the percentage of instances where a non-malicious user was correctly recognized. A TN metric represents the percentage of instances where the malicious users correctly were recognized. A FP metric is the percentage of instances where the system **100** classifies the malicious users as non-malicious ones, while a FN metric is the percentage of instances where the system **100** classifies non malicious users as malicious ones. In an example, the sum of the four metrics (TP metric, TN metric, FP metric, FN metric) is equal to 100%.

[0093] FIG. 5A illustrates a graph **500** representing the FPR versus threshold values. Signal **502**

indicates the FPR corresponding to the threshold values in the range of $[-1.5, 1.5]$. FIG. 5B illustrates a graph 550 representing the FNR versus threshold values. Signal 552 indicates the FNR corresponding to the threshold values in the range of $[-1.5, 1.5]$. In an aspect, TP, TN, FP and FN were measured between a threshold range of $[-1.5, 1.5]$. From the measured values of the TP, TN, FP and FN, the FPR and the FNR were calculated using equations 3 and 4. The simulation was stopped after 2,000 s. The objective of the system 100 is to decrease both FPR and FNR by combining the two modalities (fingerprint and face) as compared to their individual values in the different biometric techniques.

[0094] When the threshold value $\gamma=1.5$ is chosen, the two modalities (i.e., fingerprint and face) are always used. The probability of the FNR will greatly increase since the user will be classified as an intruder if he/she fails the fingerprint or the face or both tests. The FNR can be mathematically modeled by equation (15) given as below:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{FNR} &= \text{FNR}_{\text{finger}} + \text{FNR}_{\text{face}} - (\text{FNR}_{\text{finger}} \times \text{FNR}_{\text{face}}) \\ [00008] \text{ Considering FNR} &= \text{FNR}_{\text{finger}} + \text{FNR}_{\text{face}} - (\text{FNR}_{\text{finger}} \times \text{FNR}_{\text{face}}) \quad (15) \\ &= 0.182 + 0.288 - (0.182 \times 0.288) \\ &\approx 41.76\% \end{aligned}$$

[0095] Equation (15) provides a same value as seen in the simulation.

[0096] The FPR drop since the users must pass both the fingerprint test and the face detection test to be classified as a non-malicious user. The results were validated during the experimentation using equation (16).

$$\begin{aligned} \text{FPR} &= \text{FPR}_{\text{finger}} \times \text{FPR}_{\text{face}} \\ [00009] \text{ Considering FPR} &= \text{FPR}_{\text{finger}} \times \text{FPR}_{\text{face}} \quad (16) \\ &= 0.215 \times 0.277 \\ &\approx 5.96\% \end{aligned}$$

[0097] All nodes (users) have an initial trust value of zero. Moreover, the nodes cannot reach the threshold value ($\gamma=-1.5$). When $\gamma=-1.5$, then the system 100 starts to trust all users, resulting the trusted users (i.e., all the users) only use fingerprint detection. Hence, the $\text{FPR}=\rho.\text{sub.finger}=21.50\%$ and the $\text{FNR}=\phi.\text{sub.finger}=18.20\%$, is confirmed by the simulation as shown in FIG. 5A and FIG. 5B, respectively.

[0098] Finally, the values between the range $-1 \leq \gamma \leq 1.0$ also behave as predicted. The value of the FPR gradually reduces as γ is increased because increasing γ raises the bar for trusting the users, thereby forcing the system 100 to use both modalities. The frequency of usage of both modalities increases with increase in γ , thus the FPR also decreases. The value of the FNR increases with increase in values of γ because more the system 100 uses both biometrics, the higher the tendency that the non-malicious users come up as malicious users, since they must pass both biometrics.

[0099] In the present disclosure, a specific security technique (trust management system) is incorporated into decision level multi-biometric to improve the malicious user detection of the system 100 while reducing the energy consumption of the system 100. In an aspect, the trust management system is used to handle the dynamic evaluation of trustworthiness. The trust management system tracks nodes past interactions in the network to detect malicious attacks and selfish attitudes. It is observed that there is no exact trust threshold value that will provide the best value for all the parameters (i.e., energy, TP, TN, FP, and FN). However, the threshold value of 0 is an optimal value within the limits of the experiment carried out, when the initial trust value of the users is 0.

[0100] FIG. 6 illustrates a working flowchart 600 of a moving target defense multi-biometric system (MTMS), according to aspects of the present disclosure. The system 100 employs a moving target defense (MTD) to reduce the FNR. The MTD is a defense strategy where a system switches between different methods to prevent an attacker. The MTD is the concept of controlling change across multiple system dimensions in order to increase uncertainty and apparent complexity for attackers, reduce their window of opportunity and increase the costs of their probing and attack

efforts. In the system **100**, the MTD switches between the TMS and the multi-biometric system.

[0101] Step **602** includes getting, via the processing circuitry **114**, a predefined moving target probability (P.sub.r). In an example, the system administrator may provide a value “P.sub.r”.

[0102] Step **604** includes generating, via the processing circuitry **114**, a random number between 0-1 as Q. The system **100** uses the generated random number to choose one of the working operations. The system **100** chooses to operate as the multi-biometric system with the probability P.sub.r and as the trust-based multi-biometric system (TMS) with the probability of (1-P.sub.r).

[0103] Step **606** includes determining whether the predefined probability is greater than or equal to the random number.

[0104] When the P.sub.r is less than the Q, the system **100** is configured to operate as the TMS. The TMS performs step **608** that includes inputting, via the processing circuitry **114**, a user ID and retrieving a trust value for the user from a trust database **108**.

[0105] When the trust value is greater than the trust threshold, then step **608** includes obtaining the scanned user fingerprint using the fingerprint scanner **102**. The processing circuitry **114** configured to map the scanned user fingerprint with the stored user fingerprint fetched from the fingerprint database **110**. If the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as the stored user fingerprint, then the processing circuitry **114** applies the reward to the trust value to increase the trust value.

[0106] Step **612** includes storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user. Step **614** includes authenticating the user to allow access to the system **100**.

[0107] If the scanned user fingerprint is not equal to the stored user fingerprint, then step **608** includes applying a punishment to the trust value to decrease the trust value. Step **612** includes storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user. Step **616** includes denying access to the system **100**.

[0108] When the trust value is less than the trust threshold, then step **608** includes obtaining the scanned user fingerprint using the fingerprint scanner **102** and obtaining the captured user face using the camera **104**. The processing circuitry **114** configured to map the scanned user fingerprint with the stored user fingerprint fetched from the fingerprint database **110**. If the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as the stored user fingerprint, then the step **608** includes applying the reward to the trust value to increase the trust value. Step **612** includes storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user. Step **614** includes authenticating the user to allow access to the system **100**.

[0109] If the scanned user fingerprint is not equal to the stored user fingerprint, then step **608** includes applying the punishment to the trust value to decrease the trust value. Step **612** includes storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user. Step **616** includes denying access to the system **100**.

[0110] When the probability is greater than or equal to the random number, the system **100** is configured to operate as the multi-biometric system (as explained in FIG. 7). The multi-biometric system performs step **610** that includes reading face biometrics. Step **610** further includes reading fingerprint biometrics. Step **610** further includes inputting the user ID. The processing circuitry **114** is configured to substantially map the scanned user fingerprint with the stored user fingerprint fetched from the fingerprint database **110** and to substantially map the captured user face with the stored user face fetched from the face database **112**. When the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as the stored user fingerprint and the captured user face is substantially the same as the stored user face in the face database **112**, step **610** further includes applying the reward to the trust value to increase the trust value. Step **612** includes storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user. Step **614** includes allowing access to the system **100**.

[0111] When the scanned user fingerprint is not equal to the stored user fingerprint and the captured user face is not equal to the stored user face in the face database **112**, step **610** applies a punishment to the trust value to reduce the trust value. Step **612** includes storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user. Step **616** includes denying access to the system **100**.

[0112] In the TMS, the system **100** reads the user's trust value "T". If T is above a predefined threshold value γ , the system **100** only uses the lightweight biometric system (fingerprint biometrics). However, if the value is less than γ then the system **100** uses the multi-biometric mode (i.e., it uses both the face and the fingerprint biometrics) for authentication.

[0113] When the system **100** chooses the multi-biometric system, the system **100** uses both face biometric and fingerprint biometric together as shown in FIG. 7. The user is authenticated to allow access to the protected system **100** only when both of the biometrics substantially match their stored biometrics. Otherwise the access is denied.

[0114] FIG. 7 illustrates a working flowchart **700** of the multi-biometric system, according to aspects of the present disclosure. [0115] Step **702** includes reading face biometrics as FC using the camera **104**. [0116] Step **704** includes reading fingerprint biometrics as FP using the fingerprint scanner **102**. [0117] Step **706** includes inputting the user ID as UID. [0118] Step **708** includes mapping the scanned user fingerprint biometrics with the stored user fingerprint fetched from the fingerprint database **110** and the captured face biometrics with the stored user face fetched from the face database **112**.

[0119] When the scanned user fingerprint is not equal to the stored user fingerprint and the captured user face is not equal to the stored user face in the face database **112**, step **710** includes denying access to the system **100**. Step **712** includes applying the punishment to the trust value to reduce the trust value. Step **718** includes storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user.

[0120] When the scanned user fingerprint biometrics are substantially equal to the stored user fingerprint and the captured user face is substantially the same as the stored user face in the face database **112**, step **714** includes authenticating the user to allow access to the system **100**. Step **716** further includes applying the reward to the trust value to increase the trust value. Step **718** includes storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user.

[0121] FIG. 8A-FIG. 8B show the performance of the moving target-based multi-biometric system (MTMS) at different values of $P_{sub.r}$ as compared to the trust-based multi-biometric system (TMS). The X-axis shows the value of " $P_{sub.r}$ " for the MTMS and the result for the TMS is labeled as "trust". The Y-axis is the FNR in percentage values between 0 and 1. The modification of the system **100** aims to reduce the false-negative rate (FNR) of the access control system. The FNR is the ratio of the legitimate users that were perceived as malicious (see equation 4).

[0122] FIG. 8A illustrates a graph **800** of the performance of the MTMS as compared with the TMS that offers the best energy efficiency. Line **802** represents a FNR value of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.1$. Line **804** represents a FNR value of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.5$. Line **806** represents a FNR value when $P_{sub.r}=0.9$. Line **808** represents a FNR value of the TMS.

[0123] FIG. 8B illustrates a graph **850** of the performance of MTMS in comparison with the TMS that shows the worst energy efficiency. Line **852** represents a FNR value of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.1$. Line **854** represents a FNR value of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.5$. Line **856** represents a FNR value of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.9$. Line **858** represents a FNR value of the TMS.

TABLE-US-00002 TABLE 2 Defined TMS settings Multi-biometric Reward (α) Punishment (β) Threshold (γ) Best 0.6 0.2 0.3 Worst 0.6 0.5 0.5

[0124] The MTMS shows a lower FNR as compared to both TMSs (in worst configuration as well as best configuration). However, in both cases (in worst configuration as well as best configuration) the MTMS with $P_{sub.r}=0.1$ shows the lowest FNR. When $P_{sub.r}=0.1$, only 10% of total authentication sessions used the multi-biometric technique, while the 90% of authentication sessions used TMS. This shows that the present system **100** achieves the objective of decreasing both FPR and FNR by combining the two modalities (fingerprint and face). At $P_{sub.r}=0.5$, the system **100** shows the worst performance because the system **100** oscillates; constantly moving trusted users; yielding up and down the threshold, γ . At $P_{sub.r}=0.9$, the system **100** shows poor performance (although not as poor as $P_{sub.r}=0.5$) because the majority of the time (90% of the

time) the MTMS uses the multi-biometric system **100** that requires users to pass both biometrics before being considered legitimate users, making it hard for benign users to pass.

[0125] FIG. **9A**-FIG. **9B** show the energy consumption (in joules) of both the MTMS and the TMS. FIG. **9A** illustrates a graph **900** of the energy consumption of MTMS in comparison with the TMS, when TMS is in the best configuration. Line **902** represents energy consumption of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.1$. Line **904** represents energy consumption of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.5$. Line **906** represents energy consumption of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.9$. Line **908** represents energy consumption of the TMS.

[0126] FIG. **9B** illustrates a graph **950** of the energy consumption of MTMS in comparison with the TMS, when TMS is in the worst configuration. Line **952** represents energy consumption of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.1$. Line **954** represents energy consumption of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.5$. Line **956** represents energy consumption of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.9$. Line **958** represents energy consumption of the TMS.

[0127] FIG. **9A**-FIG. **9B** show that the MTMS consumes less energy compared to the TMS. This can be attributed to the fact that the multi-biometric part of the MTMS helps the system **100** to reach stability faster than using the TMS alone. The multi-biometric part of the system **100** helps quickly classify the attackers from benign users. Then the TMS part of the system **100** uses the energy-efficient biometric (in this case the fingerprint) for authentication. Thus, reducing the net energy consumption of the system **100**.

[0128] FIG. **10A**-FIG. **10B** show the FPR of the MTMS as compared to the TMS. The X-axis shows the value of " $P_{sub.r}$ " for the MTMS and the result for the TMS labeled as "trust". The Y-axis shows the percentage of the FPR between 0 and 1. The FPR is the portion of the malicious users accepted as benign (see equation 3).

[0129] FIG. **10A** illustrates a graph **1000** of the performance of MTMS in comparison with the TMS in terms of the FPR in the best configuration of the TMS. Line **1002** represents energy consumption of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.1$. Line **1004** represents energy consumption of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.5$. Line **1006** represents energy consumption of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.9$. Line **1008** represents energy consumption of the TMS.

[0130] FIG. **10B** illustrates a graph **1050** of the performance of MTMS in comparison with the TMS in terms of the FPR in the worst configuration of the TMS. Line **1052** represents energy consumption of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.1$. Line **1054** represents energy consumption of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.5$. Line **1056** represents energy consumption of the MTMS when $P_{sub.r}=0.9$. Line **1058** represents energy consumption of the TMS.

[0131] FIG. **10A**-FIG. **10B** show that the MTMS performs inadequately as compared with the TMS, because the addition of the multi-biometric part of the MTMS has increased the FPR. However, the value of the FPR at most is 11%.

[0132] Next, further details of the hardware description of the computing environment of FIG. **1** according to exemplary embodiments is described with reference to FIG. **11**.

[0133] In FIG. **11**, a controller **1100** is described as representative of the system **100** having an energy-efficient multi-biometric authentication of FIG. **1** in which the processing circuitry **114** is a computing device which includes a CPU **1101** which performs the processes described above/below. FIG. **11** is an illustration of a non-limiting example of details of computing hardware used in the computing system, according to exemplary aspects of the present disclosure. In FIG. **11**, a controller **1100** is described which is a computing device (that includes the processing circuitry **114**) and includes a CPU **1101** which performs the processes described above/below. The process data and instructions may be stored in memory **1102**. These processes and instructions may also be stored on a storage medium disk **1104** such as a hard drive (HDD) or portable storage medium or may be stored remotely.

[0134] Further, the present disclosure is not limited by the form of the computer-readable media on which the instructions of the inventive process are stored. For example, the instructions may be

stored on CDs, DVDs, in FLASH memory, RAM, ROM, PROM, EPROM, EEPROM, hard disk or any other information processing device with which the computing device communicates, such as a server or computer.

[0135] Further, the invention may be implemented as a utility application, background daemon, or component of an operating system, or combination thereof, executing in conjunction with CPU **1101**, **1103** and an operating system such as Microsoft Windows 7, UNIX, Solaris, LINUX, Apple MAC-OS and other systems known to those skilled in the art.

[0136] The hardware elements in order to achieve the computing device may be realized by various circuitry elements, known to those skilled in the art. For example, CPU **1101** or CPU **1103** may be a Xenon or Core processor from Intel of America or an Opteron processor from AMD of America, or may be other processor types that would be recognized by one of ordinary skill in the art. Alternatively, the CPU **1101**, **1103** may be implemented on an FPGA, ASIC, PLD or using discrete logic circuits, as one of the ordinary skill in the art would recognize. Further, CPU **1101**, **1103** may be implemented as multiple processors cooperatively working in parallel to perform the instructions of the inventive processes described above.

[0137] The computing device in FIG. **11** also includes a network controller **1106**, such as an Intel Ethernet PRO network interface card from Intel Corporation of America, for interfacing with network **1160**. As can be appreciated, the network **1160** can be a public network, such as the Internet, or a private network such as an LAN or WAN network, or any combination thereof and can also include PSTN or ISDN sub-networks. The network **1160** can also be wired, such as an Ethernet network, or can be wireless such as a cellular network including EDGE, 3G and 4G wireless cellular systems. The wireless network can also be WiFi, Bluetooth, or any other wireless form of communication that is known.

[0138] The computing device further includes a display controller **1108**, such as a NVIDIA GeForce GTX or Quadro graphics adaptor from NVIDIA Corporation of America for interfacing with display **1110**, such as a Hewlett Packard HPL2445w LCD monitor. A general purpose I/O interface **1112** interfaces with a keyboard and/or mouse **1114** as well as a touch screen panel **1116** on or separate from display **1110**. General purpose I/O interface also connects to a variety of peripherals **1118** including printers and scanners, such as an OfficeJet or DeskJet from Hewlett Packard.

[0139] A sound controller **1120** is also provided in the computing device such as Sound Blaster X-Fi Titanium from Creative, to interface with speakers/microphone **1122** thereby providing sounds and/or music.

[0140] The general-purpose storage controller **1124** connects the storage medium disk **1104** with communication bus **1126**, which may be an ISA, EISA, VESA, PCI, or similar, for interconnecting all of the components of the computing device. A description of the general features and functionality of the display **1110**, keyboard and/or mouse **1114**, as well as the display controller **1108**, storage controller **1124**, network controller **1106**, sound controller **1120**, and general purpose I/O interface **1112** is omitted herein for brevity as these features are known.

[0141] The exemplary circuit elements described in the context of the present disclosure may be replaced with other elements and structured differently than the examples provided herein. Moreover, circuitry configured to perform features described herein may be implemented in multiple circuit units (e.g., chips), or the features may be combined in circuitry on a single chipset, as shown on FIG. **12**.

[0142] FIG. **12** shows a schematic diagram of a data processing system **1200** used within the computing system, according to exemplary aspects of the present disclosure. The data processing system **1200** is an example of a computer in which code or instructions implementing the processes of the illustrative aspects of the present disclosure may be located.

[0143] In FIG. **12**, data processing system **1280** employs a hub architecture including a north bridge and memory controller hub (NB/MCH) **1225** and a south bridge and input/output (I/O)

controller hub (SB/ICH) **1220**. The central processing unit (CPU) **1230** is connected to NB/MCH **1225**. The NB/MCH **1225** also connects to the memory **1245** via a memory bus, and connects to the graphics processor **1250** via an accelerated graphics port (AGP). The NB/MCH **1225** also connects to the SB/ICH **1220** via an internal bus (e.g., a unified media interface or a direct media interface). The CPU Processing unit **1230** may contain one or more processors and even may be implemented using one or more heterogeneous processor systems.

[0144] For example, FIG. **13** shows one aspect of the present disclosure of CPU **1230**. In one aspect of the present disclosure, the instruction register **1338** retrieves instructions from the fast memory **1340**. At least part of these instructions is fetched from the instruction register **1338** by the control logic **1336** and interpreted according to the instruction set architecture of the CPU **1230**. Part of the instructions can also be directed to the register **1332**. In one aspects of the present disclosure the instructions are decoded according to a hardwired method, and in another aspect of the present disclosure the instructions are decoded according to a microprogram that translates instructions into sets of CPU configuration signals that are applied sequentially over multiple clock pulses. After fetching and decoding the instructions, the instructions are executed using the arithmetic logic unit (ALU) **1334** that loads values from the register **1332** and performs logical and mathematical operations on the loaded values according to the instructions. The results from these operations can be feedback into the register and/or stored in the fast memory **1340**. According to certain aspects of the present disclosures, the instruction set architecture of the CPU **1230** can use a reduced instruction set architecture, a complex instruction set architecture, a vector processor architecture, a very large instruction word architecture. Furthermore, the CPU **1230** can be based on the Von Neuman model or the Harvard model. The CPU **1230** can be a digital signal processor, an FPGA, an ASIC, a PLA, a PLD, or a CPLD. Further, the CPU **1230** can be an x86 processor by Intel or by AMD; an ARM processor, a Power architecture processor by, e.g., IBM; a SPARC architecture processor by Sun Microsystems or by Oracle; or other known CPU architecture.

[0145] Referring again to FIG. **12**, the data processing system **1280** can include that the SB/ICH **1220** is coupled through a system bus to an I/O Bus, a read only memory (ROM) **1256**, universal serial bus (USB) port **1264**, a flash binary input/output system (BIOS) **1268**, and a graphics controller **1258**. PCI/PCIe devices can also be coupled to SB/ICH **1220** through a PCI bus **1262**.

[0146] The PCI devices may include, for example, Ethernet adapters, add-in cards, and PC cards for notebook computers. The Hard disk drive **1260** and CD-ROM **1256** can use, for example, an integrated drive electronics (IDE) or serial advanced technology attachment (SATA) interface. In one aspect of the present disclosure the I/O bus can include a super I/O (SIO) device.

[0147] Further, the hard disk drive (HDD) **1260** and optical drive **1266** can also be coupled to the SB/ICH **1220** through a system bus. In one aspects of the present disclosure, a keyboard **1270**, a mouse **1272**, a parallel port **1278**, and a serial port **1276** can be connected to the system bus through the I/O bus. Other peripherals and devices that can be connected to the SB/ICH **1220** using a mass storage controller such as SATA or PATA, an Ethernet port, an ISA bus, an LPC bridge, SMBus, a DMA controller, and an Audio Codec.

[0148] Moreover, the present disclosure is not limited to the specific circuit elements described herein, nor is the present disclosure limited to the specific sizing and classification of these elements. For example, the skilled artisan will appreciate that the circuitry described herein may be adapted based on changes on battery sizing and chemistry or based on the requirements of the intended back-up load to be powered.

[0149] The functions and features described herein may also be executed by various distributed components of a system. For example, one or more processors may execute these system functions, wherein the processors are distributed across multiple components communicating in a network. The distributed components may include one or more client and server machines, which may share processing, as shown by FIG. **14**, in addition to various human interface and communication devices (e.g., display monitors, smart phones, tablets, personal digital assistants (PDAs)). More

specifically, FIG. 14 illustrates client devices including smart phone 1411, tablet 1412, mobile device terminal 1414 and fixed terminals 1416. These client devices may be commutatively coupled with a mobile network service 1420 via base station 1456, access point 1454, satellite 1452 or via an internet connection. Mobile network service 1420 may comprise central processors 1422, server 1424 and database 1426. Fixed terminals 1416 and mobile network service 1420 may be commutatively coupled via an internet connection to functions in cloud 1430 that may comprise security gateway 1432, data center 1434, cloud controller 1436, data storage 1438 and provisioning tool 1440. The network may be a private network, such as a LAN or WAN, or may be a public network, such as the Internet. Input to the system may be received via direct user input and received remotely either in real-time or as a batch process. Additionally, some aspects of the present disclosures may be performed on modules or hardware not identical to those described.

[0150] The above-described hardware description is a non-limiting example of corresponding structure for performing the functionality described herein.

[0151] Numerous modifications and variations of the present disclosure are possible in light of the above teachings. It is therefore to be understood that the invention may be practiced otherwise than as specifically described herein.

Claims

1-10. (canceled)

11. A non-transitory computer readable storage medium storing program instructions for biometric authentication, which when executed by processing circuitry, perform a method for multi-biometric authentication in a computer system, comprising: reading a predefined probability; generating a random number between 0 and 1; when the predefined probability is less than the random number, inputting a user ID and retrieving a trust value for a user from a trust database; when the trust value is greater than a trust threshold, then obtaining a scanned user fingerprint using a fingerprint scanner, wherein the fingerprint scanner is selected from the group consisting of an optical scanner, a capacitance scanner, an ultrasonic scanner, and a thermal scanner; when the scanned user fingerprint equals to a stored user fingerprint in a fingerprint database, applying a reward to the trust value to increase the trust value, storing the trust value as a cumulative trust value for the user, and authenticating the user to allow access to the computer system; otherwise applying a punishment to the trust value to decrease the trust value, and storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user; when the trust value is less than the trust threshold, then obtaining a scanned user fingerprint using a scanner and obtaining a captured user face using a camera; when the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as the stored user fingerprint and the captured user face is substantially the same as a stored user face in a face database, applying a reward to the trust value to increase the trust value, storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user, and allowing access to the computer system, otherwise applying a punishment to the trust value to decrease the trust value, and storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user; when the predefined probability is greater than or equal to the random number, reading face biometrics of the user using the camera; reading fingerprint biometrics of the user using the fingerprint scanner; inputting the user ID; when the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as the stored user fingerprint and the read user face is substantially the same as a stored user face in a face database, applying a reward to the trust value to increase the trust value, storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user, and authenticating the user to allow access to the computer system, otherwise applying a punishment to the trust value to reduce the trust value, and storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user.

12. The computer readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein the reward is applied by adding a predetermined reward value to the trust value and the punishment is applied by subtracting a

predetermined punishment value from the trust value.

13. The computer readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein the cumulative trust value is determined each time the user is authenticated by the computer system.

14. The computer readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein a user having a stored trust value below the trust threshold is an untrusted (untrustworthy) user, and a user having a stored trust value above the trust threshold is a trusted user (trustworthy).

15. The computer readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein the captured user face and the stored user face are particular features of a user face, in which if the scanned user fingerprint is substantially the same as the stored user fingerprint and the captured features of the user face is substantially the same as the stored features of the user face in a face database, applying a reward to the trust value to increase the trust value, and storing the trust value as the cumulative trust value for the user.
